RESEARCH REPORT / PHASE 01 / VERSION 2.0

Commercial Collections Competitor Research

India-focused competitive landscape, pricing evidence, product opportunities and recommended MVP requirements.

PREPARED FOR	PREPARED BY	REVIEW DATE
Ricoz Innovation Project discussion	Syed Nazeer	7 November 2026

Brief received

Research competitors and prepare a PRD before development. Project description: **commercial collections of overdue invoices with an indicated 15%-30% contingency fee**. Technology mandated: Next.js, Node.js + Express.js, MongoDB, Git and GitHub. These are the only confirmed project inputs.

Executive takeaways

- **Direct market validation:** FundRaksha publicly advertises 30% success-based fees for Indian business invoice recovery; CARMA Recover advertises outcome-based collections with tracking dashboards. [S1-S3]
- **International patterns:** Atradius emphasizes online claim submission and tracking; Rocket Receivables describes a contingency model; eCollect documents claim, payment and document APIs. [S4-S6]
- **Important distinction:** Chaser, Kolleno, Upflow and Gaviti are mainly receivables management software references, rather than identical outsourcing providers. [S7-S10]
- **Recommended product direction:** a secure creditor portal + internal case desk, with upload, review, status history, verified recoveries and fee transparency.
- **Open business question:** is Ricoz operating a recovery service, building a SaaS for agencies, or merely building a demo? Decide before signing off the PRD.

Evidence standard: [V] = vendor or official source confirms its own stated capability; [A] = our analysis/proposal; [?] = not established from public sources. Vendor marketing outcomes are not independently audited. This report is research, not an approved PRD, legal opinion or pricing quotation.

01 Research scope and method

Scope / assumptions

- **Primary working assumption [A]:** Indian B2B overdue trade invoices; client is the unpaid business (creditor); operator manages cases on its behalf.
- **Not assumed:** consumer lending, bank/NBFC loan collection, pan-India field staff, legal representation, automated calling or authority to hold customer funds.
- **Research method:** reviewed publicly accessible vendor product pages and documentation, the Ministry of MSME, government DPDP materials and OWASP API security guidance.
- **Limitations:** no logged-in software trials, customer interviews, legal due diligence or independently confirmed recovery statistics; some features may vary by subscription or geography.

Four distinct categories

CATEGORY	BUSINESS MODEL	EVIDENCE / USE
Managed recovery agency	Provider undertakes authorized case activity, usually with agreed charges.	FundRaksha, Atradius, Rocket Receivables. Most relevant to the brief. [S1,S4,S5]
Tech-enabled managed collections	Provider combines software with people, engagement and escalation.	CARMA Recover. Useful India workflow benchmark. [S2]
Self-managed AR SaaS	Creditor uses software to run its own reminders, collections and payments.	Chaser, Kolleno, Upflow, Gaviti. Reference for dashboard UX and automation. [S7-S10]
Statutory delayed-payment remedy	Eligible MSE suppliers file a dispute through the government mechanism.	MSME Samadhaan is an alternative process, not a private SaaS competitor. [S11]

Who has the problem? (hypotheses to test)

USER	JOB TO BE DONE	POTENTIAL FRICTION
SME owner / accounts lead	Submit invoices, check whether work has started, understand costs.	Scattered documents and unclear updates.
Collections operator	Review files, take action, keep communication history.	Missing proof, duplicate work and unowned tasks.
Administrator	Approve scope, monitor risks and verify recovered amounts.	Inconsistent statuses and financial auditability.

Research discipline: The presence of competing products confirms a product category, but does not prove a new business can win customers or operate legal collection activities. Those require customer validation and legal/operational approval.

02 India-focused competitor deep dive

FundRaksha - commercial invoice recovery [V]

Its commercial debt recovery page describes review of invoices, purchase orders and delivery evidence; negotiation and possible legal pathways; and a **30% fee on amounts recovered**, with court costs disclosed separately where applicable. Its legal site also describes treatment of partial recoveries. [S1,S3]

- **Primary audience:** Indian businesses seeking recovery of trade debts.
- **Commercial pricing evidence:** public 30% success fee. Specific scope, exclusions and extra services require contract confirmation.
- **MVP lesson [A]:** request more than an invoice file: purchase order, delivery/service proof, payment correspondence and dispute status.
- **Do not copy:** advocate assignment, court workflows or recovery promises unless authorized and staffed.

CARMA Recover / CarmaOne - managed collection platform [V]

CARMA Recover describes success-fee pricing, collection stages by days past due, digital outreach, on-ground execution, dashboards, settlement workflows and legal escalation subject to customer approval. Its published claims about geographic reach or recovery outcomes are **vendor-reported, not independent measurements**. [S2,S15]

- **Primary audience:** companies with B2B receivables and some lending/portfolio use cases; not a one-to-one match for every invoice-recovery SME.
- **Pricing evidence:** fee is described as a percentage of recovered funds, but no single universal public percentage is given.
- **MVP lesson [A]:** simple aging buckets, case owners, escalation requests, settlement approvals and immutable activity history.
- **Exclude early:** AI voice calls, field-agent dispatch and litigation functions.

India market implication

Ricoz is **not entering an empty market**. Simply adding a dashboard or stating "no recovery, no fee" is unlikely to distinguish the product. A credible entry point may be **transparent case intake and verified updates for smaller businesses** [A], pending user interviews.

Key fee finding: FundRaksha is a directly relevant 30% India example [S1]; CARMA uses a success-fee structure but does not publish one universal percentage [S2]. Neither proves that a 15%-30% band is suitable for Ricoz or financially viable.

03 International direct competitors

Atradius Collections - online collections [V]

Atradius promotes uploading overdue invoices, monitoring progress and making decisions online under a no-win, no-fee service description. [S4]

- **Observe:** short intake, easy quote request, predictable case progress.
- **Build:** creditor case dashboard, evidence-upload checklist, update timeline.
- **Defer:** multinational collection networks and multi-jurisdiction services.

Rocket Receivables - staged pricing [V]

Rocket Receivables describes a staged model and says Stage Two is contingency-based, with a published 50/50 split on recovered funds. That **50% is a specific US vendor example, not a market average**. [S5]

- **Observe:** transparent collection stage, explicit handoff to specialist workflows.
- **Build:** stage/status visibility and a clear fee explanation.
- **Defer:** US legal processes, contact scoring and proprietary skip-tracing.

eCollect - integrated claim management [V]

eCollect documents APIs for creating/updating customers, submitting claims and payments, handling documents and exchanging messages. This demonstrates a structured claim lifecycle that could later support bulk integrations. [S6]

- **Observe:** clear records for customers, claims, documents and payments.
- **Build:** relational identifiers for parties, invoices and cases, plus case activities.
- **Defer:** public partner APIs and ERP synchronization until a real demand exists.

Common pattern across direct rivals [A]: client intake -> claim assessment -> assigned action -> client-visible updates -> confirmed result -> charges. The first product differentiator is trustworthy execution, not advanced AI.

04 Adjacent AR software benchmarks

VENDOR	PUBLICLY DESCRIBED FEATURES [V]	PRACTICAL TAKEAWAY [A]
Chaser	Overdue receivables, debtor risk and payment-friction flags, actions from a central dashboard; integration support. [S7]	Show what needs attention, not only total rupees outstanding.
Kolleno	Invoices, customer profiles, tasks, promise-to-pay flows, reporting and customer-facing payment portal. [S8,S14]	Centralize case context and a clear "next action".
Upflow	AR portfolio visibility, collection workflows, payment operations and real-time metrics including DSO/CEI. [S9]	Create simple workflow and outcome metrics before AI.
Gaviti	Collection reminders, escalations, notes, task assignment, dashboards and reporting. [S10]	Separate scheduled work, notes, and confirmed payments.

Useful patterns - without copying their business model

- **Attention dashboard:** overdue balances, cases awaiting review, promises due, disputed claims, unverified receipts.
- **Activity feed:** who changed the case, when, what happened and which next step is due.
- **Human review:** a promise-to-pay is not the same as a receipt; disputes must not be hidden as "unpaid".
- **Friction reduction:** reusable creditor/debtor details, invoice attachments and guided submission.
- **Later-stage integrations:** accounting connectors, reconciled payment links, scheduled communications and analytics.

Comparison caveat: AR automation providers generally empower the creditor to collect; a managed recovery platform involves a separate operator and a service agreement. The required permissions, data flows and fees are different.

05 Evidence-based capability matrix

V = confirmed on the cited public source; - = not confirmed from pages reviewed (does not mean absent). Product examples and cited evidence are on pages 3-5.

CAPABILITY	Fund-Raksha	CARMA	Atradius	eCollect	Chaser	Kolleno	Gaviti
Online claim submission	-	-	V	V	-	-	-
Client/case tracking	-	V	V	V	V	V	V
Contingency/success fee	V	V	V	-	-	-	-
Document intake / upload	V	-	V	V	-	-	-
Payment or receipt handling	-	-	-	V	-	V	V
Reminder / workflow tools	-	V	-	-	V	V	V
Disputes / escalation	V	V	-	-	V	-	V

Interpretation: Feature claims above describe vendor pages reviewed, not hands-on tests. A blank means "not confirmed here". CARMA and some others also serve non-trade-receivable contexts. Matrix intentionally avoids numerical feature scores to prevent false precision.

The strongest MVP feature set

PRIORITY	FEATURE	WHY IT MATTERS
P0	Company-based accounts + permissions	Prevent cross-client data exposure.
P0	Invoice claim intake + evidence	Creditor starts a real case.
P0	Admin review + ownership	A human confirms case acceptability.
P0	Status history + activity log	Trust and transparency.
P0	Verified recoveries + fee breakdown	The proposed commission model requires provable math.
P1	Search, filters, aging dashboard	Operator usability and review queues.
P2	Emails, CSV imports, accounting integrations	Automation after core case lifecycle works.

Evidence gap to close: Competitor marketing tells us what products offer; only discovery calls with prospective Indian SMEs can establish which features actually matter to the initial customers.

06 Pricing and contingency-fee analysis

Comparable public evidence

PROVIDER	PUBLISHED MODEL	INTERPRETATION
FundRaksha	30% of amount recovered; additional fees/court expenses may apply under stated conditions. [S1,S3]	Direct Indian benchmark, not an industry average.
CARMA Recover	Percentage of each rupee brought back; pricing varies with aging and complexity. [S2]	Direct success-fee model, no universal rate published.
Rocket Receivables	Stage Two uses 50/50 split of collections. [S5]	US vendor context; not evidence 50% is typical.
Ricoz brief	15%-30% contemplated band (WhatsApp description).	Proposed project input; unconfirmed commercial policy.

Illustrative calculations - INR

Assume one invoice for **Rs 1,00,000**, verified partial recovery of **Rs 60,000**, no other fees or taxes. This is a hypothetical model; not an offer or accounting/tax conclusion.

RATE	VERIFIED RECOVERY	SERVICE FEE	RECOVERY LESS FEE
15%	Rs 60,000	Rs 9,000	Rs 51,000
20%	Rs 60,000	Rs 12,000	Rs 48,000
30%	Rs 60,000	Rs 18,000	Rs 42,000

Calculation [A]: Fee = verified recovered amount x agreed case rate. Recovery net of fee = verified recovery - fee, before applicable taxes/other charges. Do not calculate fee on the full invoice when only part has been recovered.

Critical fee design decisions

- **Proof:** what constitutes a cleared/verified recovery when the debtor pays the creditor directly?
- **Disputes & adjustments:** how are chargebacks, refunds, duplicate receipts and reversal entries handled?
- **Settlement:** does the fee apply to non-cash settlement, returned goods, interest or court-awarded amounts?
- **Rate configuration:** who approves a 15%, 20% or 30% rate and when is it locked for a case?
- **Funds:** no custodial wallet, automatic transfers or payout handling unless independently authorized.

07 Positioning: where could Ricoz compete?

Recommended initial positioning [A]

"A transparent case-tracking portal for Indian SMEs recovering overdue B2B invoices, with human-reviewed claims and explainable, recovery-based fees." This is a product hypothesis for management and customer validation, not an approved tagline.

Differentiation hypotheses

HYPOTHESIS	MVP EVIDENCE	HOW TO TEST
Transparent updates	Every case has status, owner, activity time and next action.	Ask 5 finance leads whether current updates are timely.
Easy intake	A guided form collects invoices and supporting proof once.	Observe 3 users submitting a dummy case.
Explainable fees	Show verified receipts, effective rate and adjustments.	Have 3 users recalculate the same invoice.
SME-friendly	Clear language, mobile responsive layout and no unnecessary screens.	Run a usability test on a mobile browser.

Possible target segment (for PRD discussion)

- Indian SMEs with overdue B2B trade invoices, single-company account ownership and small collections teams.
- Initially one currency (INR), one legal jurisdiction/operating policy and small numbers of cases.
- Avoid banks/NBFCs and consumer loans unless Ricoz explicitly selects them; the policy requirements differ.

Exclude from the first MVP

- Automated or AI-originated debtor calls, legal threats, mass WhatsApp campaigns and automated legal filings.
- Actual custody of money, financial ledger settlement or payment gateway onboarding.
- Field collection, multilingual voice agents, credit scoring and insolvency/legal case prediction.
- Cross-border cases and multi-currency fee/tax engine.

Reason: An effective prototype should simulate the allowed workflow honestly and handle sample data correctly; it should not imply authority to conduct real debt collection.

08 Recommended MVP workflow (PRD input)

Actors and access boundary [A]

ROLE	ALLOWED ACTIONS	NOT ALLOWED
Creditor	Create/view own company cases, upload evidence, view verified updates.	Viewing another creditor or altering confirmed recoveries.
Case operator	Review assigned cases, record actions, recommend settlement, flag disputes.	Approving own financial adjustments without proper authorization.
Administrator	Approve case, assign operator, verify receipts, control rate and audit.	Bypassing retention/authorization policies.

Eight-step lifecycle

STEP	TRIGGER / OUTPUT
1. Sign up	Company account and verified login (demo onboarding may be seeded).
2. Submit	Creditor submits amount, invoice number, debtor, due date and evidence.
3. Intake review	Admin accepts, rejects or asks for missing documents; rationale stored.
4. Assign	Approved case receives an operator, status and next action.
5. Work	Operator records authorized follow-up notes and disputed / promise statuses.
6. Verify receipt	Payment evidence entered, checked and approved by an authorized person.
7. Show fee	Fee breakdown and remaining invoice balance update from verified amounts.
8. Close / reopen	Case closes with an audit trail; reopening requires reason and permission.

Suggested state names

Draft -> Submitted -> Needs information / Rejected / Accepted -> In progress -> On hold / Disputed / Partial recovery -> Resolved / Closed. Treat status changes as explicit transitions, not unrestricted text edits.

Prevent a common error: A debtor promising to pay is not money recovered. The dashboard must distinguish *promised*, *recorded*, and *verified* receipts.

09 Functional requirements and test gates

These are proposed acceptance ideas for PRD v0.1, not commitments by Ricoz.

ID	REQUIREMENT [A]	PASS CONDITION
F01	Company-scoped registration and sign-in	User A cannot read User B company data through UI or API.
F02	New claim + evidence	Mandatory fields validated; file uploaded; created case can be found.
F03	Admin intake decision	Approve/reject/request info updates status and logs actor/time.
F04	Case assignment	Only authorized staff assign or reassign an operator.
F05	Activity timeline	New status/note appears chronologically with author and time.
F06	Verified receipt entry	Approval changes recovered and outstanding totals exactly once.
F07	Fee calculation	15/20/30% test cases compute from verified amount only.
F08	Case list and filters	Users can search by status, invoice and date with access checks.
F09	Responsive UX	Usable on mobile and laptop; no hidden submission controls.
F10	Error handling	Invalid input displays useful feedback; no raw stack traces.

Suggested milestone representing an early 45% slice [A]

Because the overall scope is undefined, "45%" cannot be measured honestly until agreed. A reasonable **feature-based demonstration** to propose is: secure authentication, company isolation, invoice/case submission, basic admin review, and an activity timeline. Fee logic and full operator flows can be the next milestone.

- Deploy a demo with synthetic invoices; provide a working URL and demo credentials.
- Maintain a GitHub README with setup, completed features, screenshots and test instructions.
- Report remaining scope explicitly; do not claim a percentage based only on hours or UI screens.

10 Approved stack and architecture proposal

LAYER	REQUIRED TECHNOLOGY	PROPOSED JOB
Frontend	Next.js	Mobile-friendly creditor and internal operations interfaces.
API	Node.js + Express.js	Authentication, validation, access policies, case and finance APIs.
Data	MongoDB	Company-scoped cases, invoices, histories, receipts, audit records.
Code	Git + GitHub	Issues, branches, code review and documented releases.

Core collections [A]

COLLECTION	MOST IMPORTANT FIELDS
organizations	id, name, legalIdentityStatus, contact, status
users	organizationId, role, email, credentialsRef, accountStatus
debtors	organizationId, legalName, contact, identifiers
invoices	organizationId, debtorId, reference, amountMinor, currency, dueDate
cases	organizationId, invoiceId, operatorId, state, feeRateBps
documents	organizationId, caseId, category, protectedStorageRef
activities	organizationId, caseId, actorId, event, timestamp
recoveries	organizationId, caseId, amountMinor, verifiedStatus, uniqueRef
auditEvents	actorId, organizationId, eventType, beforeAfter, timestamp

Money representation: Store integer minor currency units (paise) or a suitable decimal type, never floating-point arithmetic for contractual amounts. Verify duplicate receipts and rate changes. This is an engineering recommendation, not a vendor feature.

Minimal API grouping [A]

/auth - login, session, roles; **/organizations** - tenant settings; **/cases** - creation and workflow; **/documents** - secure attachments; **/recoveries** - verified receipts; **/audit** - privileged history.

11 Security, India-specific boundaries and metrics

Operational and legal boundaries

- **MSME Samadhaan:** an eligible micro or small enterprise with valid Udyam registration can use the official delayed-payment mechanism; this is a possible alternative referral pathway, not a substitute for legal review. [S11]
- **Data protection:** the DPDP Rules, 2025 and phased implementation of the Act make privacy engineering important. Avoid storing more personal data than necessary; obtain professional review of applicable obligations. [S12]
- **Different sector, different regulations:** bank/NBFC loan collections and ordinary B2B trade claims are not interchangeable. The platform must not generate or send legal notices itself without authorized oversight.
- **Responsible collections:** no harassment, deception, unauthorized disclosure, unapproved messages or misrepresentation of account balances.

Minimum engineering controls

- Tenant-scoped access on **every API endpoint** and document download; deny-by-default operator permissions.
- Validated forms; safe file handling; secure sessions; rate limiting; secrets outside version control; regular backups.
- Append-only audit trail for status, rate, reassignment and recovery events; protect evidence of verification.
- Unit tests for fees and negative/reversal cases; integration tests across two independent company accounts.

OWASP highlights broken object-level authorization and broken authentication as major API risks; this is directly relevant for confidential case data. [S13]

Early operational metrics [A]

METRIC	DEFINITION / DATA CAUTION
Intake completion	Submitted claims / started submissions (only count meaningful sessions).
Time to first review	Elapsed time from submission to first authorized decision.
Unverified balance	Recorded receipts still awaiting verification; not revenue.
Confirmed recovery	Sum of verified cleared receipts, net of verified reversals.
Cases awaiting action	Accepted cases with overdue next-action date.

12 Questions for Rajesh before PRD sign-off

01. Is this a **recovery service operated by Ricoz**, software for outside agencies, or only a demonstration product?

02. Is the target market **Indian B2B trade invoices only**, or should bank/NBFC loans and consumer accounts be included?

03. Who will actually review disputes, contact debtors and authorize settlements?

04. What is the minimum scope: creditor portal only, or creditor + operator + admin dashboards?

05. Does 15%-30% mean a fixed rate per case, a tier, or negotiable fee? What counts as recovered funds?

06. How do payments reach the creditor, and who verifies them? Should the product merely **record** payment evidence?

07. What is the expected date of PRD review and the **agreed acceptance definition of 45%**?

08. Who approves the PRD, owns the GitHub repository, reviews code and confirms delivery channels?

Recommended next sequence

STAGE	OUTPUT	APPROVAL GATE
1. Research	This evidence-based competitor report	Supervisor confirms target customer and business model.
2. PRD v0.1	Requirements, diagrams, user stories and tests	Supervisor reviews proposed features and scope.
3. Demo foundation	Auth, tenant-safe case intake and basic admin review	Feature-by-feature acceptance, not vague percentages.
4. Working MVP	Timeline, roles, receipt verification and fee calculations	Demo and negative-path tests.
5. Handover	Demo link, code, README, test results and roadmap	Ownership, hosting and next team roles confirmed.

Decision requested: Approve one business model and one MVP boundary. Until then, research can be shared, but full development estimates, production claims and fee handling are speculative.

Sources - primary vendor evidence

Sources accessed/reviewed on 7 November 2026. Click the blue URL to inspect the original page. Public vendor pages are evidence of their published statements, not independent validation of results.

[S1] FundRaksha - commercial debt recovery and 30% fee
https://www.fundraksha.com/services/commercial-debt-recovery

[S2] CARMA Recover - outcome-based B2B receivables
https://www.carmaone.ai/carma-recover

[S3] FundRaksha Legal - fee and partial recovery example
https://legal.fundraksha.com/

[S4] Atradius Collections - online debt recovery
https://atradiuscollections.com/global/services/online-debt-collection

[S5] Rocket Receivables - Stage Two contingency collections
https://rocketreceivables.com/features/stage-two/

[S6] eCollect - claims, payments, messages, document API
https://docs.ecollect.org/v2/api/

[S7] Chaser - debtor relationship dashboard
https://help.chaserhq.com/debtor-relationship-management-dashboard

[S8] Kolleno - help centre feature catalogue
https://help.kolleno.com/en/

[S9] Upflow - B2B accounts receivable management
https://upflow.io/accounts-receivable-management-software

[S10] Gaviti - collections management features
https://gaviti.com/product/a-r-collections-management/

[S14] Kolleno - customer portal help article
https://help.kolleno.com/en/articles/6367471-customer-portal

Sources - public institutions & research notes

[S11] Govt of India - MSME Samadhaan and eligibility
https://ramp.msme.gov.in/ramp/RAMP-initiative/msme-samadhaan/msme-samadhaan

[S12] Govt of India (PIB) - DPDP Rules 2025
https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2190014&lang=2&reg=3

[S13] OWASP - API Security Top 10 (2023)
https://api-security.owasp.org/editions/2023/en/0x11-t10/

[S15] CARMA - debt collection software / reporting
https://www.carmaone.ai/debt-collection-software

What the sources do - and do not - prove

- **Prove:** the linked organization publicly advertises the described functionality, pricing language or policy information as of the review date.
- **Do not prove:** that customer results, security certifications, exact performance or business viability independently meet any claimed level.
- **Not verified:** internal vendor screens, proprietary enterprise pricing, feature gating, operational licenses, actual customer satisfaction and market share.
- **Proposals:** priority order, feature roadmap, positioning, acceptance criteria and metrics are derived product recommendations, not instructions received from Ricoz.

Ethics and decision memo

Do not send sample invoices containing real people's data or commercial secrets into third-party AI tools. During the prototype stage use fictional debtor records and sample receipt references. The project owner should confirm agreements, approved handling procedures, intellectual property ownership and legal review before a production deployment.

Recommended handoff: Share this competitor research for review, then prepare PRD v0.1 with clearly marked assumptions and an approval checklist.